

Adult Resuscitation

Important Assessment Points On Ill Patients

- **General Appearance** – Mental status, level of distress
- **Breathing** – Normal effort? Increased effort? Decreased effort? Abnormal Sounds? Respiratory rate – fast, slow, agonal, apnea? Decreased air movement? Pulse ox? Ability to speak in full sentences?
- **Circulation**
 - Heart rate – tachycardia or bradycardia?
 - Peripheral pulses – normal, weak, or absent?
 - Skin color – pale, cyanotic? Capillary refill less than two seconds?
 - Blood pressure – normal or low?
 - Bleeding – active external bleeding? Suspect internal bleeding? (GI bleed, intra-abdominal bleed, intracranial bleed, vaginal bleed)
- **Level of consciousness** – Comatose? Lethargic? Oriented to person, place, time, and event? Intoxicated?
- **Temperature / Skin** – Hot? Cool? Clammy? Rash? Trauma?
- **Cervical spine** – Need for spinal motion restriction? (Fall? MVC? Unconscious with possible / unknown trauma? Intoxicated?)

EMT/AEMT

- Follow General Medical Care Guideline

Difficulty Breathing or Respiratory Distress

- Bag / Valve / Mask (BVM) ventilations with airway adjunct/s to maintain SpO₂ >94%
- Igel placement and ventilation

Patient Unresponsive, Pulseless and Not Breathing

- CPR per Clinical Operating Guidelines

Paramedic

- Treat per appropriate Clinical Operating Guideline

Patient Unresponsive, Pulseless and Not Breathing

- Adult Cardiac Arrest – Initial Care Guideline

Lightning strike and drowning patients

Airway/ventilations are of equal importance to chest compressions.

Provide adequate ventilation at 30:2 rate until intubated and then 100 compressions/min with ventilation every 6-8 seconds.